

Airlocks disengaged. Commence docking procedures...



After navigating distant space and time (and the dark recesses of your front pocket) your iPod needs to dock with a worthy docking station. Which one should it be?

Siddharth Parwatay
siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

Take a moment to look at those devices atop. The chrome and metal beauties gleaming at you are not merely speakers. They have speakers yes, but they're something more; a category of gadgets that was spawned by another iconic device - the iPod. Beyond audio, these sound systems have another purpose. Style, design, sophistication - they're all this

rolled into a set of speakers and a docking station.

For our test we received a wide range of iPod Docks from every conceivable price range and category. The price band ranged from ₹2,999 to ₹85,000. We split up these aural beauties into three categories based on use case. The sub ₹6,000 docks were distinctly bed-side devices. They had the whole alarm clock and snooze system going for them, besides of course giving you a place to cradle and simultaneously charge your

iPod, iPhone or iPad. The other distinct category was portables - docks that have battery backup and are therefore portable. The remaining were all thrown in together to battle it out. Let's start with the first category.

Bedside docks

This category featured the Philips Fidelio DS 1100, Logitech's Bedside Dock for iPad and the F&D i224. The contender from F&D incidentally was the dock with the lowest price tag. Let's look at each one.

Philips Fidelio DS 1100

The DS 1100 is undoubtedly the best looking of the three bed side docks. It's shaped like a donut with the iPod sitting in the center. The body is made of this milky white translucent plastic through which shines a digital clock on the front. The bottom of the device emits a soothing soft glow so you won't fumble to reach the dock at night. The drivers are housed behind a gray circular fabric and are geared to produce omnidirectional sound. Some of the cool features include